

Endangered Species Interactive Website – Complete Design & Organization Master Plan

This document outlines a complete strategy for creating a highly visual, immersive, and interactive endangered species website project. The goal is to create a project that goes far beyond traditional slides and instead feels like an interactive science exhibit or mini documentary experience. The website should balance visual appeal, organization, scientific accuracy, storytelling, and creativity.

1. Core Design Philosophy

- The website should feel immersive and cinematic rather than academic and text-heavy.
 - Use large visuals, animations, environmental effects, and storytelling.
 - All information must remain easy to navigate and easy to understand.
 - The interface should feel like an interactive infographic.
 - Use concise text blocks rather than large essays.
 - Every section should include relevant imagery and visual storytelling.
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2. Main Website Structure

- Landing Screen with cinematic background image or looping environmental video.
 - Animated title introducing the endangered species.
 - Central radial navigation menu.
 - Interactive content sections that open dynamically.
 - Smooth transitions between sections.
 - Dedicated sections for all rubric requirements.
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3. Radial Menu Organization

- Place the endangered species image or silhouette in the center.
 - Arrange section buttons in a circular radial pattern.
 - Buttons should glow or animate on hover.
 - Each radial section should open a fullscreen panel or animated overlay.
 - The radial menu should remain accessible from every section.
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4. Suggested Radial Menu Categories

- Meet the Species
 - Habitat & Location
 - Food Web
 - Adaptations
 - Predators
 - Climate Stressors
 - Patterns of Change
 - Human Impact
 - Conservation & Solutions
 - Evolution
 - Extinction Risk
 - Sources & Citations
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5. Landing Page Features

- Fullscreen hero image or animated environment.
 - Animated particles such as leaves, snow, bubbles, rain, or dust.
 - Large species title and scientific name.
 - Short emotional tagline.
 - Enter Website button with animation.
 - Ambient environmental audio (optional).
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6. Visual Design Recommendations

- Use a consistent environmental theme matching the species habitat.
 - Apply cinematic gradients and lighting effects.
 - Use large typography for headers.
 - Maintain strong contrast for readability.
 - Use motion carefully to avoid overwhelming users.
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7. Animation Recommendations

- Smooth hover effects.
- Parallax scrolling backgrounds.
- Animated section transitions.
- Interactive hover states for images and diagrams.

- Subtle particle systems.
 - Animated energy flow arrows in food web.
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8. Meet the Species Section

- 5 interesting facts.
 - Scientific classification.
 - Quick statistics.
 - Population size.
 - Fun visual cards.
 - High quality species imagery.
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9. Habitat & Location Section

- Interactive map.
 - Biome description.
 - Climate information.
 - Habitat loss comparison images.
 - Environmental statistics.
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10. Food Web Section

- This should be one of the most interactive sections.
 - Display at least 10 organisms.
 - Use arrows to show energy transfer.
 - Hovering over organisms should highlight connected species.
 - Use animations for ecosystem flow.
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11. Adaptations Section

- Display at least 3 adaptations.
 - Include both behavioral and physical adaptations.
 - Use interactive cards or animated panels.
 - Show close-up images or diagrams.
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12. Climate Stressors Section

- Demonstrate habitat destruction visually.
 - Include rising temperatures, droughts, flooding, or ocean acidification.
 - Use graphs, overlays, and animated comparisons.
 - Explain how climate change impacts survival.
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13. Human Impact & Solutions Section

- Show both harmful and positive human actions.
 - Include conservation programs.
 - Display before/after recovery images.
 - Add a section called 'How You Can Help'.
 - Include carbon footprint reduction examples.
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14. Evolution Section

- Evolution timeline.
 - Closest living relatives.
 - Evolutionary tree.
 - Differences between related species.
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15. Extinction Risk Section

- Current conservation status.
 - Population decline statistics.
 - Threat levels.
 - Interactive warning visuals.
 - Animated extinction counter.
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16. Sources & Research Section

- Every image and fact should be cited.
- Use trusted research websites.

- Separate image credits and scientific references.
 - Include links to conservation organizations.
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17. Recommended Technologies

- HTML5
 - CSS3
 - JavaScript
 - GSAP animations
 - SVG radial menu system
 - Optional: Three.js for advanced visual effects
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18. Recommended Workflow

- Phase 1: Build structure and radial navigation.
 - Phase 2: Add all required rubric content.
 - Phase 3: Add animations and visual effects.
 - Phase 4: Optimize readability and presentation.
 - Phase 5: Final polish and testing.
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19. Key Success Strategy

- Do not prioritize visuals over clarity.
 - Avoid large walls of text.
 - Make navigation intuitive.
 - Ensure every section directly supports rubric requirements.
 - Focus on storytelling and immersion.
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20. Advanced Feature Ideas

- Animated habitat destruction simulator.
- Interactive population counter.
- 3D rotating animal model.
- Mouse-follow lighting effects.
- Environmental weather system.

- Scroll-triggered cinematic animations.
 - Audio-reactive animations.
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This project has the potential to feel far beyond a standard middle school science presentation. If designed correctly, it can resemble a professional interactive educational exhibit while still clearly presenting all required scientific content. The strongest projects combine organization, readability, storytelling, visual polish, and creativity.